

SHATTERED DREAMS

INDIA'S NANO-FERTILISER AMBITIONS, WHICH PROMISED TO MAKE THE COUNTRY SELF-RELIANT IN FERTILISERS, HAVE FIZZLED OUT DUE TO DOUBTS OVER EFFICACY

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INDIA'S NANO fertiliser drive, launched in 2021, has run out of steam.

In 2021, the Centre allowed commercial production of nano urea as “revolutionary and game changing.” It claimed the drive would make India self-reliant and end fertiliser imports by 2025; cut fertiliser use and subsidy outgo; raise yields and nutritional quality of crops; prevent soil, air, and water pollution; and restore soil nutrient imbalance caused by excessive urea use.

Six years later, India is back to square one, staring at a fertiliser supply constraint due to

the war in West Asia, which is likely to be felt when rabi sowing starts after the monsoon.

NO FORCED SALE

The first nano urea plant came up in Gujarat in 2022. The Centre was convinced about its utility and thus promoted its widespread adoption.

But a Fertiliser Control Order (FCO) published March 13, 2026, amended the FCO, 1985, to stop its use. “The manufacturer shall ensure that there shall be no forced sale of nano fertilisers by tagging with other fertilisers or any other kind of agri-inputs.”